

Isabella Urbano-Trujillo

Trondheim, Norway • (+49) 152 0326 0912 • isabellaurbanot@gmail.com

Profile

Interdisciplinary researcher working at the intersection of applied microeconomics, causal inference, and public policy. Experienced in impact evaluation using experimental and quasi-experimental methods, with a focus on welfare, inequality, and social protection. Incoming PhD student at NTNU, where my work will examine the economic sustainability of welfare reforms through counterfactual cost-benefit analysis. Committed to rigorous, policy-relevant research that bridges disciplinary boundaries across economics, statistics, and machine learning.

Education

PhD Student, Welfare and Social Protection

2026 – 2029 (incoming)

Norwegian University of Science and Technology — Trondheim, Norway

- Doctoral researcher on the *WelGain* project funded by the Research Council of Norway, which examines the visibility bias in welfare policy evaluation, the tendency for fiscal costs to dominate public and political debate while social gains remain unmeasured. The project aims to develop a cost-benefit framework integrating intangible welfare gains, applying it to two Norwegian reforms using counterfactual causal inference methods, and testing experimentally whether providing citizens with evidence on hidden gains affects support for social programs. Supervisor: Prof. Roberto Iacono.

MSc, Data Science for Public Policy

2023 – 2025

Hertie School — Berlin, Germany

- Thesis: *Bridging data gaps with machine learning: Food security predictions in Sudan*.
- Full tuition scholarship and DAAD stipend. Student commencement speaker, 2025.

BSc, Economics

2016 – 2021

Pontificia Universidad Javeriana — Cali, Colombia

- Graduated *Cum Laude*. Thesis: *Educational gaps and private contributions in public schools in Colombia*.
- Scholarship for best GPA, 2019. Student commencement speaker, 2021.

Research Experience

Junior Researcher (pre-doctoral)

Aug 2025 – Jul 2026

International Security and Development Center — Berlin, Germany

- Supported the design and implementation of experimental research; collected, cleaned, and analyzed household survey and secondary data.
- Applied econometric, causal inference, and machine learning methods for impact evaluation; wrote reports and academic articles.
- Impact evaluations: *Building Local Resilience in Syria*; *Resilience and Crisis Response in Earthquake-Affected Areas in Syria and Türkiye*; and *Restoring Food and Nutrition Security in Sudan* — assessing the effects of livelihood, gender, and agricultural interventions on food security, welfare, resilience, and women's empowerment.

Research Assistant (working student)

Jan 2024 – Jul 2025

International Security and Development Center — Berlin, Germany

- Conducted literature reviews, managed large household survey datasets, and performed quantitative and qualitative analysis to support report writing.

Junior Researcher

Nov 2021 – Aug 2023

CoreWoman — Bogotá, Colombia

- *Finances with a Gender Lens* — evaluated (using a synthetic control method) a financial-inclusion program for women.

- *Transforming the Care Economy through Impact Investing* — documented care-economy enterprises across the Global South to mobilize capital to the sector.
- *Women's Participation in Value Chains in PDET Municipalities* — strengthened gender equity in firms across conflict-affected territories in Colombia.
- *Gender-Smart Investing Capacity Building Facility* — designed a gender-lens investing strategy for the Yunus Social Business Fund.

Data Visualization Consultant

Sep 2022 – Jun 2023

Pontificia Universidad Javeriana — Cali, Colombia

- Built the food-system platform *PlaSa Colombia* for the [Alliance of Bioversity International](#) and the International Center for Tropical Agriculture, centralizing public and private data and creating interactive Tableau dashboards.

Research and Data Assistant

Nov 2019 – Jan 2021

Pontificia Universidad Javeriana — Cali, Colombia

- Supported public- and private-sector research projects through data wrangling, quantitative analysis, report writing, and data visualization.
- Contributed to the *Feria de Cali* (2019) and *Petronio Álvarez Festival* (2018) economic impact studies (ISBN 978-958-5137-14-1).

Teaching Experience

Graduate Teaching Assistant

Jan 2025 – Jul 2026

Hertie School — Berlin, Germany

- Environmental Economics (Spring 2025 and 2026) and Economics I (Fall 2025): led two weekly lab sessions over a 12-week semester; created slides and designed and graded problem sets, tests, and assignments.

Undergraduate Teaching Assistant

Jul 2019 – Dec 2020

Pontificia Universidad Javeriana — Cali, Colombia

- Tutored macroeconomics, microeconomics, and econometrics; taught data-processing workshops in Stata and R; and data-visualization workshops in Tableau.

Conference Presentations

34th Annual IAFPE Conference

Jul 2026

International Association for Feminist Economics

- *Transit Captives: Gendered Risk of Sexual Harassment and Assault in Public Mobility Spaces – Bogotá as a Case Study* (with Sofía García-Durrer). Panel: Exploring Vulnerabilities & Risk.

Other Professional Experience

Procurement Assistant

Jun 2021 – Nov 2021

Belcorp — Tocancipá, Colombia

Logistics Intern

Jan 2021 – Jun 2021

AB InBev — Bogotá, Colombia

Technical Skills & Languages

Programming Stata, R (advanced); Python, SQL (intermediate)

Tools LaTeX, GitHub, Tableau, Power BI, Excel

Methods Causal inference (e.g. DiD, RDD, SCM, matching), econometrics (e.g. panel data, fixed effects, IV), impact evaluation, geospatial analysis, machine learning

Languages Spanish (native); English (C1); German (A2)